

Materia Mundi



Player's Handbook

I ntroduction

This book contains the rules for a role-playing game in the "old school" style of the first tabletop RPGs created in the 1970s.

What's a Role-Playing Game?

This is a *role-playing game*. In it, you play the role of an adventurer in a fantasy world, where magic is real and heroes venture forth on dangerous quests for fortune and fame. Characters gain experience by overcoming danger and recovering treasure, growing in power and ability as they do so.

You need at least two people to play this game, although it's far more enjoyable with a troupe of four or more people. You don't need a board or playing pieces to play (although many players find them useful) - all that you really need are these rules, some dice, a pencil and paper, and your imagination.

Definitions

When you set up to play this game, one person will be designated as the *referee*. Each of the other people plays the role of a fantasy character, designated a *player character*. The person assigned to play that player character is their *player*. You can think of a player as an actor in a partially improvisational theatre performance, and the referee as the director. The group of player characters adventuring together are called the *party*.

How to "Win"

"Winning" and "Losing" are not the right way to think about a fantasy adventure game. While the referee controls monsters and traps that might threaten the player characters, the referee should not see themselves as playing "against" the players - they are a guide and a judge, whose primary job is to keep the action flowing and present the adventure to the party in a neutral manner. They are not "on the players' side", but they are equally not "on the monsters' side"; their job is to create and present an exciting adventure.

Keep in mind that the referee's primary job is to maintain the sense that the party exists within a world. If the rules in this book result in an obviously absurd situation, it is the referee's job to ignore them, and figure out what happens instead.

Dice

For ease of play, this game only uses two kinds of dice: the d20 and the d6. Each player generally needs two d20's, and between three and six d6's.



Player Characters

Origin

Every character has an origin, representing their cultural and ethnic background. This is much broader than our world's ethnicities - this is a world with dwarves, elves, and even stranger creatures! Some origins even have a few abilities that tend to be higher or lower, on average, than a human's.

Your origin will determine which character classes you can take. Each origin always has one martial class, one expert class, and one magic-user class to choose from, and any origin can choose to become a Priest. Within those choices, your abilities determine which classes you would be better or worse at.

Abilities

Your character has six primary abilities, which define how tough, strong, nimble, smart, perceptive, and outgoing they are compared to the average person. Each of these abilities ranges from -3 (severely disabled) to +3 (world-class prodigy), with most humans typically having abilities of +0. An ability of -1 or lower is noticeably worse than the average human's, while an ability of +1 or higher is noticeably better.

Rolling Abilities

When you create a character, you will roll 3d6 and add the dice together for each of these abilities, generating a number from 3 to 18 which will then convert into a -3 to +3 ability value. Certain origins will provide you with enhanced or deficient abilities; you roll 4d6 for those abilities, then ignore either the highest or lowest die and add the rest together to determine that ability.

You always roll your abilities in order; this might result in a character with exceptionally high intelligence but abysmally low wisdom, but such is the way of things sometimes. As an option, the referee might decide to allow anyone playing a human character to choose and swap a single pair of abilities after rolling.

Barring serious injury or miraculous blessing, these numbers will be your character's innate abilities throughout your career — you can increase your skill at anything with sufficient training and effort, but raw inborn ability will always be what it is.

My abilities suck! What do I do?

Sometimes the dice just aren't your friend. If you roll a character that seems utterly unsuited to adventuring, the referee might tell you to start over and roll all your abilities again. Don't expect this, however, and don't feel too worried if your abilities are sub-par. As long as you have at least one exceptional ability (+1 or better), you should try to stick with it and see how your character can learn to overcome whatever disabilities the dice might have saddled them with at the beginning of their career. Also, keep in mind that this is a cooperative game - the other members of your party should have your back in situations when you are disadvantaged, and you should have theirs when the tables are turned. You're all in this dungeon together!

What Abilities Do

Here are each of the six abilities, in order, along with a brief description:

Strength is your character's raw physical power, including their muscle strength and speed. It determines how well (and how hard) they can hit with melee weapons, how much they can lift and carry, and their general athleticism.

Constitution is your character's toughness, endurance, and health. It determines how long they can stay in a fight, as well as how well they resist poisons and diseases.

Dexterity is your character's hand-eye coordination, balance, and agility (although some facets of agility are a matter of strength rather than dexterity). It determines how well you can avoid getting hit, and gives you an edge with various trainable physical talents.

Intelligence is your character's logical thinking and deduction capability. It determines how well you notice out-of-place details, and gives you an edge with various mental talents.

Wisdom is your character's intuitive awareness and common sense. It determines how well you resist various magical or mind-controlling effects, and gives you an edge with various trainable intuitive talents.

Charisma is your character's courage, spirit, and likeability. It determines how well you resist being frightened or discouraged, and gives you an edge with various social talents.

Character Class

This game tracks your character's talents and experience through a concept called a *character class*. Your character class is an abstraction that represents the general focus of your character's talents as an adventurer; each class focuses on a different aspect of the game — fighter classes focus on combat prowess, expert classes focus on skills and tricks, and magic-user classes focus on magic and the supernatural. As you advance, your character will gradually get better at the talents that your character class focuses on, while also improving their general ability to survive hardship and danger.

Classes and Themes

The class names presented here are generic "catch-all" categories for various kinds of proficiency - for example, a "Scout" might represent a thief, treasure-hunter, diplomat, spy, assassin, wandering noble dilettante, or any number of other professions. If you have a particular background in mind for your character, work with your referee to determine which character class best fits your idea.

Creating a Character

STEP 1: Roll Origin

Roll a d6 to determine your origin: human, dwarf, or fey. If you roll a fey origin, you then roll another d6 to determine which kind of fey you are. The referee might instead decide to allow each player to choose their origin.

Most non-humans have two enhanced abilities and one deficient ability (at least, enhanced or deficient compared to humans). Note these; you'll use them in the next step.

STEP 2: Roll Abilities

Roll 3d6 for each of your Abilities, starting with Constitution, then Strength, then Dexterity, then Intelligence, then Wisdom, then Charisma. The chart on the next page will convert this roll into a number between -3 and +3, which measures how good (or bad) you are at actions related to that ability.

Characters with a non-human origin will have one or two enhanced abilities, and possibly one deficient ability. If the ability you are rolling is an enhanced ability for your origin, reroll the lowest die and choose the better roll before adding the dice together. If the ability you are rolling is a deficient ability for your origin, reroll the highest die and choose the worse roll. Human characters do not have any enhanced or deficient abilities, but the referee might decide to allow the players of a human character to swap one pair of abilities.

Step 2a: Attack and Saving Throws

Your character has two attack throw thresholds and six saving throw thresholds. Your melee attack throw is adjusted based on your Strength, while your ranged attack throw is adjusted based on your Dexterity. Each of your six saving throw thresholds is adjusted based on a different ability.

Each attack throw or saving throw threshold starts at 14+ if your ability is average (+0). Otherwise, adjust the relevant threshold, starting at 14 — a positive ability lowers your threshold, while a negative ability increases the threshold. The result is your starting attack throw threshold or saving throw threshold, which you will compare to a d20 roll result whenever you make an attack throw or saving throw.

Step 2b: Adjust Talents

Each character has various talents, each of which relates to different adventuring tasks. Each talent has a "threshold" from 6+ to 2+; whenever you perform a task related to that talent, you will roll a d6 and compare it to your threshold for that talent.

By default, you have a 5+ threshold in each talent. If you have any abilities above or below +0, some talents will begin at a 6+ or 4+ threshold instead. Each talent is linked to a different ability; for each ability that is below or above +0, determine which of those talents will begin better or worse than normal.

STEP 3: Choose Your Character Class

Each origin has a number of character classes to choose from - one warrior class, one expert class, and one magic-user class. Any origin can also choose the Priest class.

Each class relies on their abilities in different ways. Warriors will benefit from higher Strength and Constitution, while experts will benefit from higher Dexterity and Wisdom, and magic-users might benefit from higher Intelligence, Wisdom, or Charisma depending on the nature of the magic that they wield.

Step 3a: Set Hit Points

Your starting maximum hit points are equal to 6 + your Constitution, plus any bonuses to your hit die from your class. Fighter classes gain a +2 class bonus to each hit die, while expert or magic-user classes might get a +1 bonus or no hit die bonus at all.

Step 3b: Note Martial Proficiencies

Some classes gain some amount of weapon and armor training. Note whether you are trained in the use of non-simple weapons, armors, or shields.

Step 3c: Note Expertise

Some classes gain expertise in some talents. Note any expertise talents with an asterisk.

STEP 4: Choose Starting Equipment

Choose any starting equipment that is reasonable for your character to have. Each class has a list of recommended starting equipment, or the referee might give you a list of options to choose from.

Character Details

Origin

Start creating a new character by rolling a d6 to determine your origin. If you roll a 6 (fey origin), roll another d6 to determine which type of fey you are (elf, gnome, or beastfolk).

D6	Origin	Height	Adjusted Abilities
1-3	Human	4d6+54 in	none
4	Human Barbarian (choose from Fey class list)		
5	Dwarf	2d6+40 in	+Con, +Str, -Dex
6	Fey (roll another d6 to determine which type)		
D6	Fey Type	Height	Adjusted Abilities
1-3	Elf	3d6+50 in	+Dex, +Wis, -Con
4-5	Gnome	1d6+30 in	+Dex, +Cha, -Str
6	Beastfolk	5d6+50 in	+Str, +Dex, -Int

The dice results presented here are meant to represent population demographics typical for the Successor Kingdoms; the referee is encouraged to adjust them to reflect the nature of their own campaign setting. For example, a campaign set entirely within civilization might extend the 1-3 'human' roll to 1-4 and replace the 6 'fey' roll with 'gnome', ignoring the d6 fey type roll altogether.

Abilities

Once you have determined your origin, roll 3d6 in order to determine each of your abilities, or roll 4d6 (dropping the highest or lowest) for any of your origin's adjusted abilities. Abilities with a [+] drop the lowest die, while abilities with a [-] drop the highest die. Add all three dice together and consult the following chart, writing the ability referenced (-3 to +3) on your character sheet.

3d6	Ability	Description	Talent Adjustments
3	-3	Disabled	3 linked talents are 6+
4-5	-2	Impaired	2 linked talents are 6+
6-8	-1	Below Average	1 linked talent is 6+
9-12	+0	Average	All talents are 5+
13-15	+1	Above Average	1 linked talent is 4+
16-17	+2	Exceptional	2 linked talents are 4+
18	+3	Prodigy	3 linked talents are 4+

Each ability adjusts any saving throws, attack throws, weapon damage, or other rolls that are based on that ability. It also determines the number of talents linked to that ability that are adjusted, either to 6+ or to 4+.

Saving Throws

Each ability has an associated saving throw. A saving throw is made by rolling a d20 and comparing it to a threshold, which is the number you need to match or beat on the d20 to successfully save vs. a threat of that nature.

Constitution vs. Doom (*i.e. disease or poison*)

Strength vs. Hold (*i.e. knockdown or paralysis*)

Dexterity vs. Blast (*i.e. a cone, ray, or explosion*)

Intelligence vs. Trick (*i.e. illusion or beguilement*)

Wisdom vs. Curse (*i.e. a magic spell*)

Charisma vs. Fear (*i.e. morale checks*)

Each saving throw threshold depends on the sum of your ability + your class level:

-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10+
17+	16+	15+	14+	13+	12+	11+	10+	9+	8+	7+	6+	5+

Attack Throws

You also have two attack throws - one for ranged attacks, and one for melee attacks. Your melee attack throw threshold is always equal to your Strength saving throw, and your ranged attack throw threshold is always equal to your Dexterity saving throw. You must match or beat this value on a d20 roll to hit an enemy with that kind of attack.

Hit Dice and Carrying Capacity

In addition to saving throws and attack throws, there are two more traits linked directly to your abilities:

Hit Die

Your hit die is used to determine your maximum hit points, as well as your rate of healing. Whenever you are asked to roll a hit die, you roll a d6 and add your Constitution; if you have a negative Constitution and your hit die total would be less than 1, treat the roll result as a 1 instead. Fighter classes and dwarves gain a bonus to their hit die.

Carrying Capacity

Your character can only carry so much before the weight slows them down. Each character has a carrying capacity of 6 + their Strength ability, and an encumbrance threshold of half that amount (round down). Carrying gear in excess of your encumbrance threshold halves your dash speed, up to a maximum practical burden equal to your carrying capacity.

Talents

There are 12 talents, each linked to a different ability. Each talent determines the threshold for various d6 task checks, which are made by rolling a d6 and comparing it to that talent's threshold. Talents usually begin at a threshold of 5+, but if your linked ability is positive, that many talents linked to that ability begin at 4+ instead; or, if your ability is negative, that many begin at 6+. You may choose which talents to assign your 6+, 5+, or 4+ thresholds to from each ability, or roll a d6 to randomly assign the higher or lower starting threshold.

Your **Dexterity** talents are Agility, Finesse, and Stealth. **Agility** is your full-body athleticism, and is used for climbing and other athletic feats. **Finesse** is your hand-eye coordination, and is used for detailed work like picking a lock or assembling a clockwork contraption. **Stealth** is your ability to move your body within an environment, to avoid making noise or being seen.

Your **Intelligence** talents are Lore, Medicine, and Science. **Lore** is your linguistic ability, "book learning" and capacity to remember trivia, while **Medicine** is your understanding of living bodies and how to maintain or restore their health, and **Science** is your grasp of physical and magical phenomena and the rules that govern them.

Your **Wisdom** talents are Alertness, Intuition, and Survival. Your **Alertness** measures your ability to pick up details and clues from your environment, determine which ones are important, and know how to respond to them. **Intuition** is your "common sense" and how well you can listen to your gut, both in social situations and in more unusual circumstances. Survival is your ability to navigate the wilds and survive within them, including finding or creating shelter, food, water, and other necessities..

Your **Charisma** talents are Bearing, Charm, and Wit. **Bearing** is your ability to project authority, command respect, and maintain your composure in tense situations. **Charm** is your ability to project trust, warmth, or anything else that could influence another creature's long-term attitude towards you. Finally, **Wit** is your ability to be persuasive, whether you are trying to change another creature's beliefs or just convince them to perform some task or action.

Ability Checks

Sometimes, the result of an action will be determined purely by your character's ability, regardless of any training or experience they might have. An Ability check rolls a d6 and adds the appropriate ability. (In a sense, Hit Dice are a kind of ability check.) The referee determines the threshold for success based on the circumstances.

Easier and Harder Rolls

Any attack throw, saving throw, task check, or ability check that your character might roll can be made easier or harder by various circumstances. When circumstances combine to make a roll easy, you roll two dice and use the better roll. When circumstances combine to make a roll hard, you roll two dice and must use the worse roll. If a roll is neither hard nor easy, you roll a single die.

If multiple circumstances make a situation easier while other circumstances make the same situation harder, each circumstance making the situation easier cancels out one circumstance making the situation harder, unless the referee decides that a particular circumstance overwhelms all the others.

If there are multiple circumstances all making a situation easier or harder, the referee might declare that it is now impossible to succeed or fail at that task, and not call for a roll at all. The referee is the ultimate arbitrator of whether a particular action is possible for a particular character; both your level of talent and the difficulty of the circumstances will be taken into account. In general, as a rule of thumb, the referee shouldn't make saving throws impossible or automatic in most circumstances, while talent checks should often become automatic or impossible as a matter of course, simply based on the players' descriptions of their actions and how they interact with the reality of the situation.

Difficulty	Roll
Automatic	No roll necessary
Easy	roll 2 dice (choose better)
Normal	roll 1 die
Hard	roll 2 dice (choose worse)
Impossible	No roll possible

Multiple Attempts

Unless the referee decides otherwise, each subsequent attempt of the same action is one difficulty step harder than the last, as you run out of things to try.

Rewarding Ingenuity

A large part of a fantasy adventure game is coming up with clever solutions to problems. If the party's approach to a particular task is particularly clever or effective, the referee will lower the difficulty of that task check accordingly, or possibly just declare that the task is successful and move on.

Choosing a Character Class

Once you have an origin and your six abilities, you can choose a character class. Each origin has its own set of three classes to choose from: one fighter class, one expert class, and one magic-user class.

Class and Origin

Human characters that are from advanced "civilized" societies can choose between the Warrior, Scout, or Wizard classes, while fey characters and humans from "barbarian" societies choose between the Champion, Hunter, or Druid, and all Dwarves choose from the Stalwart, Delver, or Dweomersmith. Any origin can choose the Priest class, although human priests are by far the most common.

Hit Points

Each class has a "hit die", which is a d6 + your Constitution + a bonus based on your class (not all classes will give a bonus). Once you've picked your class, your character's maximum hit points are the maximum possible roll of your hit die (as if the d6 had rolled a '6').

Martial Training

Your class might also provide you training in various military weapons and armors. Martial training allows you to use all weapons, armor, or shields without difficulty; without it, many weapons are harder to use, and you become easier to hit while wearing inappropriate armor. Even with training, medium or heavy armors still make all stealth checks harder.

Talent Training

Expert classes train a talent of their choice each time they gain a class level, including level one. Each expert class has a different list of talents that they can train.

Expertise

Some classes provide expertise in various actions; expertise makes all actions under its purview easier, allowing almost-impossible feats of skill. The referee is the final arbiter of what actions are or aren't physically possible for an expert to attempt with their expertise.

Class Feats

Each class also gives you one or more class feats, such as sneak attack or some kind of magic ability. The rules for each class feat will be explained with that class.

Experience

You begin play at level 1; as you survive each adventure, you will gain experience that will eventually advance your class level. Each adventure that you successfully return home from grants you one experience, although a particularly clever solution to an adventure's challenges might gain you an additional experience for that adventure. Whenever your experience equals your next class level, reset your experience to zero and gain that level.

Prime Ability

If you have exceptionally high or low abilities in your class's prime ability, you will gain class levels faster or slower than normal. If your prime ability is +1 or better, you reset your experience to one, rather than zero, after you gain a new level. On the other hand, if your prime ability is -1 or lower, you must earn that much additional experience before you can gain a new level.

Gaining a Level

Each time you gain a class level, you lower your thresholds for each of your attack and saving throws by 1. Then, you roll a hit die and add it to your maximum hit points.

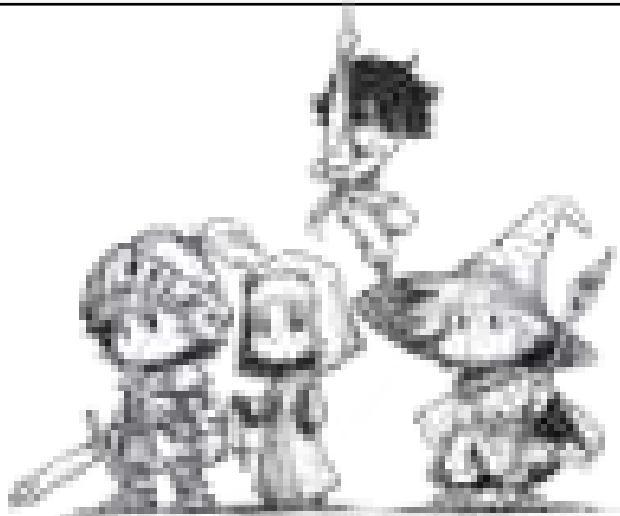
Talent or Feat Training

Expert classes train a talent of their choice each time they gain a class level, while magic-user classes gain training in specific talents at each even class level, and fighter classes gain a new fighter feat at each even class level.

Attack & Saving Throws

As you level up, remember that each of your attack and saving throw thresholds depends on the sum of your ability + class level:

-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10+
17+	16+	15+	14+	13+	12+	11+	10+	9+	8+	7+	6+	5+



Warrior

(Human Fighter)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Strength*

Hit Die: *d6+Con+2*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Longsword, heavy armor, shield, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Warriors are familiar with every kind of weapon, armor, and shield.

Improved Critical Hit

If your attack throw threshold is 9+ or better, you achieve a critical hit whenever your attack throw beats your threshold by 10 or more.

Fighter Feats

At levels 2, 4, 6, and 8, choose one of the following fighter feats:

Fighter Feats

At specific class levels, a fighter chooses and gains one of the following class feats that they do not already possess:

Cleave

Whenever your melee attack action reduces a creature to zero hit points, you can apply any excess damage to another creature within reach that isn't harder to hit. The new target applies its armor to the attack as normal.

Defender

Any creature within reach of your melee weapon that attacks a target other than you provokes an opportunity attack from you.

Deflect Blows

When you guard or evade, you double your armor rating.

Dual-Wield

You may wield a medium weapon in your off-hand as if it was a light weapon.

Leadership

When an ally within 5 paces fails a save vs. Fear, you can make a Bearing check at the same difficulty to turn it into a success.

Mounted Combat

When you ride a properly-trained mount, the bond between rider and mount is sufficiently strong that you operate effectively as a single unit, using your mount's movement during your action as if it was your own movement, and allowing you to perform your own action as normal.

Riposte

When you successfully parry an attack, you may immediately counter-attack as part of your parry. Additionally, whenever an attacker misses you while you are guarding, they provoke an opportunity attack from you.

Talent Training

You may train **Agility**, **Stealth**, **Alertness**, **Survival**, or **Bearing**. Each of these choices counts as a separate feat, so you can choose a different talent to train at a future class level.

Weapon Expertise

You may choose a particular type of weapon or shield to gain expertise in: **blades**, **axes**, **bludgeons**, **flails**, **spears**, **bows**, **crossbows**, or **shields**. Your attack throws with armaments of that type are easier.

**Class Features**

Prime Ability: *Dexterity*

Hit Die: *d6+Con*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Light crossbow, two daggers, light armor, lockpicking tools, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Scouts are familiar with every kind of weapon, but only simple armors and shields.

Talent Training

Each time you gain a level, you gain training in your choice of **Agility**, **Finesse**, **Stealth**, or **Alertness**. At levels 5 and 9, you may instead gain training in any one talent of your choice.

Scout's Expertise

Climbing (**Agility**) and hiding (**Stealth**) are particularly easy for you. You automatically succeed at any hiding or climbing action that another class could attempt, while climbing a sheer wall or hiding in mere shadows is rolled at normal difficulty for you. You cannot apply this expertise if you are encumbered, wearing medium or heavy armor, or using a shield.

Sneak Attack

You use your ranged attack threshold when you attack a target that is not aware of you, and the attack is a critical hit if each of its damage dice exceeds your Stealth threshold.

Talents

All character classes use talents, but experts especially rely on them. Your Dexterity, Intelligence, Wisdom, and Charisma each determine your starting threshold for three different talents; if your ability is +0, then all three of those talents will start at a threshold of 5+. A negative ability adjusts that many talents to a starting threshold of 6+, while a positive ability adjusts that many to 4+. Each time you gain a class level, you pick one of your talents and improve its threshold by 1, to a minimum threshold of 2+.

Agility (*Dexterity*) to climb surfaces, maintain balance, and perform precise athletic actions.

Finesse (*Dexterity*) to pick locks, disarm traps, operate machinery, or craft or repair items.

Stealth (*Dexterity*) to move silently without being noticed, hide from view, surprise or ambush an enemy, or pick pockets.

Lore (*Intelligence*) to understand a language, decipher a code, or recall any knowledge involving history, religion, or culture.

Medicine (*Intelligence*) to brew an elixir or toxin, or to diagnose or treat injury or disease.

Science (*Intelligence*) to brew a potion, enchant or identify a scroll or magic item, notice the presence of supernatural forces, or recall any knowledge involving math or engineering.

Alertness (*Wisdom*) to detect a hidden trap or secret door, to listen or watch for enemies, and avoid being surprised by ambushes.

Intuition (*Wisdom*) to read the emotions and intentions of living creatures, or to get a "gut sense" of danger or extreme foolishness.

Survival (*Wisdom*) to navigate the wilderness, hunt or forage for food, follow others' tracks or hide your own, or set up camp.

Bearing (*Charisma*) to maintain composure, manage hirelings and followers, or improve your allies' morale.

Charm (*Charisma*) to sway another intelligent creature's attitude towards you.

Wit (*Charisma*) to influence another intelligent creature's immediate behavior or beliefs.

Wizard

(Human Magic-User)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Intelligence*

Hit Die: *d6+Con*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Spellbook, dagger, quarterstaff, robes, potion belt, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Wizards are not familiar with any non-simple weapons or armor. Additionally, wearing any armor at all interferes with their ability to prepare and cast arcane magic.

Talent Training

At levels 2 and 6, you gain training in **Lore**; at levels 4 and 8, you gain training in **Science**.

Arcane Spellcasting

You begin play with a spellbook, which holds two first-circle spells, one second-circle spell, and one third-circle spell, all subject to referee approval. As you find other spellbooks or spell scrolls in the dungeon, you may copy them into your own spellbook.

Each sunrise or sunset, you can prepare a number of arcane spells from your spellbook based on your level, which you can cast during the day. Once a spell is cast, it becomes un-prepared. You can prepare spells of a lower circle than indicated.

Preparing During Exploration

You can prepare spells during exploration, if you have an empty preparation of a suitable circle. This takes a number of Science checks equal to the spell's circle; each check takes one exploration turn spent studying a spellbook that has the chosen spell and applying its arcana in magic ink to an area on the wizard's body.

Cantrips

Each spell also gives you a cantrip, which is a smaller version of the spell that can be cast at-will without un-preparing the spell.

Arcane Rituals

You can also cast arcane spells from your spellbook as rituals; each ritual takes one exploration turn per circle. You may perform any spell up to a circle of half your level (round up) as a ritual. Each turn that you perform a ritual requires a Science check, or the ritual fails. If successful, a ritual's effect happens on the next exploration turn after it is completed.

Arcane Magic and Armor

If you wear light armor, you can maintain one fewer first-circle and one fewer second-circle preparation. If you wear medium or heavy armor, you cannot cast prepared spells at all.

Arcane Spell Preparations					
Level	First	Second	Third	Fourth	Fifth Circle
1	1	-	-	-	-
2	2	-	-	-	-
3	2	1	-	-	-
4	2	2	-	-	-
5	2	2	1	-	-
6	2	2	2	-	-
7		3	2	1	-
8		2	2	2	-
9			3	2	1



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Charisma*

Hit Die: *d6+Con*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Quarterstaff, medium armor, prayer book, holy symbol, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Priests are not familiar with any non-simple weapons or armor.

Talent Training

At levels 2 and 6, you gain training in **Intuition**; at levels 4 and 8, you gain training in **Bearing**.

Domain of Faith

All priests choose a domain of faith, usually by joining a holy Order dedicated to that domain. You may perform the miracles associated to your domain, as well as any common miracle, using any prayer strip of the same or higher circle - regardless of what miracle was originally prepared into it.

Divine Miracles

You may prepare miracles into prayer strips at sunrise and sunset, which you can use to perform their associated miracles. Once a miracle is performed, its prayer strip burns to ash.

Preparing During Exploration

You can prepare during exploration, if you have an empty preparation of a suitable circle. This takes a number of Bearing checks equal to the miracle's circle; each roll takes one exploration turn spent in intense prayer.

Rebuke the Unholy

You use your action to flourish a holy symbol and make a Bearing check to attempt to drive back every unholy creature within a 5-space cone that is your level or lower. You may instead attempt to drive back a single creature that is higher level, but your saving throw is harder. Each affected creature functionally becomes panicked for as long as you focus, even if it is normally immune to fear-based effects. If you are fifth level or higher, any affected targets with only one hit die are destroyed or banished, instead of driven back. At ninth level, affected targets with two hit dice are destroyed as well.

Divine Rituals

You can also perform miracles from your prayerbook as divine rituals; each ritual takes one exploration turn per circle. You may perform any ritual from any domain, up to a circle of half your level (round up). Each round that you perform a ritual requires a Bearing check, or the ritual fails. If successful, a ritual's effect happens on the next exploration turn after it is completed.

Sworn Oaths

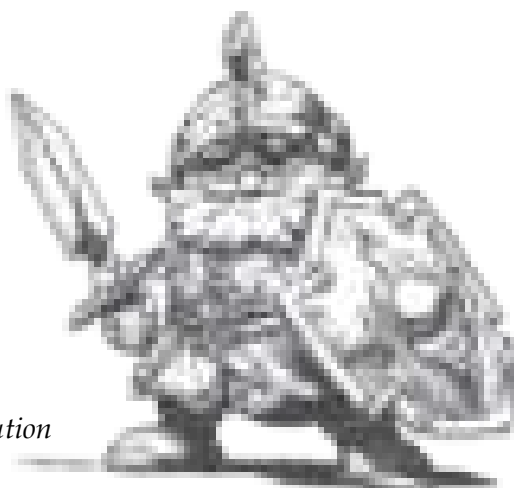
Divine blessings can bestow semi-permanent effects on anyone who swears and upholds a particular oath as the ritual is performed. Any blessing requiring focus to maintain can instead be maintained via sworn oath. Violating a sacred oath will immediately reverse the effects of the blessing, turning it into a curse that can only be removed once you have atoned for the transgression.

Prayer Strip Preparations					
Level	First	Second	Third	Fourth	Fifth Circle
1	1	-	-	-	-
2	2	-	-	-	-
3	2	1	-	-	-
4	2	2	-	-	-
5	2	2	1	-	-
6	2	2	2	-	-
7		3	2	1	-
8		2	2	2	-
9			3	2	1

Dwarven Classes

Stalwart

(Dwarf Fighter)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Constitution*

Hit Die: *d6+Con+2*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Ax, crossbow, heavy armor, shield, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Stalwarts are familiar with every kind of weapon, armor, and shield. Additionally, you may wield medium and heavy weapons as if you were a medium-sized creature.

Improved Critical Hit

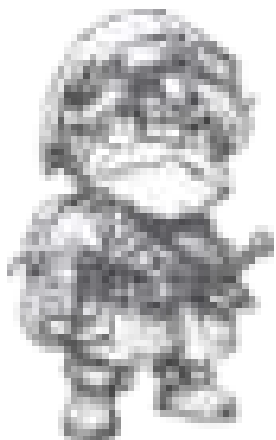
If your attack throw threshold is 9+ or better, you achieve a critical hit whenever your attack throw beats your threshold by 10 or more.

Indefatigable

Your saving throws vs. Doom, Hold, and Fear are easier.

Fighter's Feats

At level 2, you gain the Deflect Blows fighter feat, and at level 4, you gain the Defender fighter feat. At levels 6 and 8, choose one of the fighter feats from page 13 that you have not already gained.



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Wisdom*

Hit Die: *d6+Con+1*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Pickaxe, crossbow, medium armor, potion belt, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Delvers are familiar with every kind of weapon, armor, and shield.

Talent Training

Each time you gain a level, you gain training in your choice of **Finesse**, **Science**, **Alertness**, or **Survival**. At levels 5 and 9, you may instead gain training in any one talent of your choice.

Armored Stealth

Your **Stealth** checks are not penalized when you wear medium armor which has been properly fitted and prepared to not reflect light or make noise. You can prepare armor with a **Finesse** check as an exploration action.

Stonesense

When in a natural cave, or any other structure comprised primarily of stone, a dwarf may spend an exploration turn tapping the walls with a hard object and listening carefully, then make a **Survival** check to map out the area for 5 paces in all directions. You can even detect passageways on the other side of solid walls.



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Intelligence*

Hit Die: *d6+Con+1*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Hammer, crossbow, heavy armor, potion belt, smith's tools, artisan's tools, dungeoneer's kit

Martial Training

Dweomersmiths are familiar with every kind of weapon, armor, and shield.

Talent Training

At levels 2 and 6, you gain training in **Finesse**; at levels 4 and 8, you gain training in **Science**.

Dweomercraft

You begin play with a craftbook, which holds two common alchemical formulae and two common magic item blueprints. As you find other formulae or blueprints in the dungeon, you may copy them into your own craftbook.

Each sunrise or sunset, you can prepare dweomers from your craftbook, which are volatile alchemical formulae or magic item enchantments. You can choose to prepare dweomers of a lower rarity than indicated.

Preparing During Exploration

You can prepare alchemy dweomers during exploration, if you have fewer than your maximum number of dweomers prepared; or you may use this feat to recharge a dweomer magic item of the appropriate rarity that has expended its charge. This takes a number of successful Science checks equal to the item or dweomer's rarity; each roll is one exploration turn spent studying your craftbook and enchanting the dweomer.

Dweomer Rituals

You can also perform certain dweomers from your craftbook as rituals; each first-circle ritual takes one exploration turn. At third level, you can also perform second-circle rituals, each of which takes two exploration turns; at fifth level, you can perform third-circle rituals, which take three exploration turns. Each turn that you perform a ritual requires a Science check, or the ritual fails. If successful, a ritual's effect happens on the next exploration turn after it is completed.

Dweomer Preparations			
Level	Common	Uncommon	Rare
1	1	-	-
2	2	-	-
3	2	1	-
4	2	2	-
5	2	2	1
6	2	2	2
7		4	2
8		3	3
9			6

Fey and Barbarian Classes

Champion

(Fey Fighter)



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Strength*

Hit Die: *d6+Con+2*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Greatsword, light armor

Martial Training

Champions are familiar with all weapons and shields, but only simple armors.

Improved Critical Hit

If your attack throw threshold is 9+ or better, you achieve a critical hit whenever your attack throw beats your threshold by 10 or more.

Battle-Trance

Beginning at level 2, as you attack another creature with a melee weapon, you can enter a battle-trance that lasts until the end of combat. If you hit with that attack, anyone within 10 paces that can see you must save vs. fear or be frightened of you.

While in a battle-trance, you cannot evade or perform task actions, but your saving throws vs. Fear automatically succeed, and you add your level to your melee attack damage rolls.

Champion Initiation

At level 2, choose one of the following Champion initiations, gaining all of its effects whenever you enter a battle-trance. Elves always choose the Mystic initiation, while beastfolk always choose an animal initiation appropriate to their form.

Mystic

A mystic champion may roll Agility while guarding in battle-trance to deflect a melee or ranged attack with their bare hands, if that attack passes within reach. If they succeed, they may immediately make an attack throw to redirect the attack to any target within the original attacker's reach if they deflect a melee attack, or to any target within 5 paces of the champion if they deflect a ranged attack.

Bear

A Bear champion halves all damage received while frenzying if they are not wearing armor.

Boar

A Boar champion achieves a critical hit on a charge attack while frenzying if any of their damage dice match or beat their Agility.

Panther

A Panther champion who frenzies while unarmored and wielding only light melee weapons may make two attacks per round - one fast attack, and one slow attack.

Raven

A Raven champion doubles their movement speed while in frenzy if unencumbered and unarmored, and adds their level to their ranged weapon attack damage rolls.

Serpent

A Serpent champion can sneak and hide while in frenzy, can perform a sneak attack while hidden, and can charge from hiding.

Shark

A frenzying Shark champion doubles their swimming speed, and their melee attacks against injured creatures are easier (a creature is injured if it has fewer than half its maximum hit points).

Wolf

When a frenzying Wolf champion declares a melee attack, all other attacks made against the champion's target this round are easier.

Fighter Feats

At levels 4, 6, and 8, choose one of the fighter feats from page 13.



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Dexterity*

Hit Die: *d6+Con*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Shortbow, two daggers, light armor

Martial Training

Hunters are familiar with every kind of weapon, but only simple armors and shields.

Talent Training

Each time you gain a level, you gain training in your choice of **Agility**, **Stealth**, **Alertness**, or **Survival**. At levels 5 and 9, you may instead gain training in any one talent of your choice.

Hunter's Expertise

Tracking and navigating (**Survival**) are particularly easy for you. You automatically succeed at any tracking or navigation task that another class could attempt, while tasks that are impossible for other classes, such as retracing the actions and condition of a creature merely by studying its tracks, navigating without any signs or landmarks merely by the patterns of the terrain and wildlife, or befriending and training an undomesticated wild animal, are rolled at normal difficulty for you.

Sneak Attack

You use your ranged attack threshold when you attack a target that is not aware of you, and the attack is a critical hit if each of its damage dice exceeds your Stealth threshold.



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Charisma*

Hit Die: *d6+Con*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Two daggers, quarterstaff, medium armor, musical instrument

Martial Training

Bards are not familiar with any non-simple weapons or armor.

Talent Training

Each time you gain a level, you gain training in your choice of **Finesse**, **Lore**, **Charm**, or **Wit**. At levels 5 and 9, you may instead gain training in any one talent of your choice.

Bardsong

Starting at second level, whenever you focus entirely on singing or playing music, you can weave a Dream or Song glamour into the performance with a circle up to half your level (round down). Performing a bardsong requires a number of successful **Charm** checks equal to its circle; each check takes one combat round.

Magical Intuition

You may make a **Lore** check to attempt to activate any magic item or prepared magic, regardless of its origin. Common items are easy to activate, while rare items are hard; prepared magic of a circle less than half your level is at normal difficulty, while prepared magic of a circle up to your level is at hard difficulty.



Class Features

Prime Ability: *Wisdom*

Hit Die: *d6+Con*

Recommended Starting Equipment

Quarterstaff, dagger, light armor, potion belt

Martial Training

Druids are not familiar with any non-simple weapons or armor. Additionally, wearing steel armor or wielding a steel weapon will interfere with their ability to prepare and cast primal magic.

Talent Training

At levels 2 and 6, you gain training in **Medicine**; at levels 4 and 8, you gain training in **Survival**.

Primal Druidcraft

You begin play knowing four first-circle druid glamours. Unlike a wizard, you do not need a spellbook to prepare glamours; once you learn a glamour, you know how to prepare it from memory. You may learn new glamours from druids, fair folk, or intelligent fey beasts willing to teach them to you, and may learn new wild shape glamours by communing with the natural animals or fey beasts that you wish to learn to transform into.

Each sunrise or sunset, you can prepare a number of glamours into talismans based on your level, which you can cast during the day. Once a glamour is cast, its talisman becomes un-prepared. You can prepare glamours of a lower circle than indicated.

Preparing During Exploration

You can prepare primal glamours during exploration, if you have an empty talisman of a suitable circle and element. This takes a number of Survival checks equal to the chosen glamour's circle; each roll takes an exploration turn spent preparing the talisman.

Wisps

You may also befriend small elemental fey spirits, called wisps. By investing preparation into a wisp, you enable it to perform any one elemental glamour on your behalf, up to that preparation's circle.

Primal Rituals

You can also perform primal glamours as rituals; each ritual takes one exploration turn per circle. You may perform any glamour up to a circle of half your level (round up) as a ritual. Each exploration turn that you perform a ritual requires a Survival check, or the ritual fails. If you succeed, the ritual's effect happens on the exploration turn after it is completed.

Primal Magic and Iron

If are touching iron or steel, or if you have any iron or steel items on your person, you cannot prepare or cast any primal glamours.

Primal Glamour Preparations					
Level	First	Second	Third	Fourth	Known
1	1	-	-	-	4
2	2	-	-	-	6
3	2	1	-	-	8
4	2	2	-	-	10
5	2	2	1	-	12
6	2	2	2	-	15
7		3	2	1	20
8		2	2	2	30
9			3	3	All

Beginning An Adventure

The first step in any adventure story is getting there. The world in a fantasy adventure game is a vast and dangerous place which must be navigated carefully; although ancient roads built by long-forgotten empires may cross the landscape, often no one has maintained them for generations, and any that are well-traveled enough to be clear of debris and animal predators often hide bandits and cutthroats instead.

Overland Travel

Overland travel happens in four-hour shifts. Each day of travel has a budget of about 8 hours of labor that can be reasonably expected of the party, split into two such shifts; any more than that and the party can expect to become fatigued in short order.

A typical day of travel looks like this: the party wakes up about an hour before dawn, and begins the normal daily preparation - including donning armor, preparing spells or prayers, or any other relevant pre-adventuring activities. After two hours of preparation and breakfast, camp is broken down over another hour, and the party readies for travel. The party then travels steadily for four hours, then breaks for two hours to eat, rest, and consult their maps. Then a second shift of travel, and then the party spends an hour setting up camp before retiring for the evening.

Marches and Leagues

Maps copied from the Old Empire's survey records are typically divided into hexes for convenience, with each large hex measuring a twenty-four mile march, subdivided into eight three-mile leagues; on a well-traveled road with no hazards or interruptions, a well-stocked adventuring party can expect to cross a single league in about an hour, and a single march in one day.

Difficult terrain, heavy burdens, or bad weather might cause the party to become bogged down within a hex, requiring an Agility or Survival check to make any further progress. Each member of the party must succeed for the group to be able to advance; the group may attempt clever solutions to make the roll easier or aid the rolls of the less athletically-inclined members.

Navigating

Before each four-hour shift of travel, the party should declare who is navigating, who is keeping watch, and who is attending to other duties. The referee makes a secret Survival test on behalf of each navigator at the start of the shift, to determine whether the party becomes lost.

Stealth - The party may choose to employ stealth while traveling, halving their speed. For each league of travel that the party moves through stealthily, each character rolls a Stealth check with difficulty determined by the terrain and each character's armor and encumbrance. If everyone in the party succeeds at their Stealth checks, then they surprise any random encounter that they stumble across.

Forced March - The party can attempt to force-march through a league, allowing them to attempt two league-crossings in one hour; each time they do so, each member of the party must succeed at a Survival check or suffer 1d6 damage. Terrain and the encumbrance of each party member might make this test easier or harder; it gets consecutively harder for each additional shift of travel without a full day of rest, or each further hour of forced march.

Third Shift - In addition to forced march, a party may decide to attempt a third shift of travel, granting them an additional 4 hours of travel in a day. A third shift also requires a Survival check to avoid damage.

Random Encounters

Each league of travel comes with the chance of a random encounter. The nature of those potential encounters, and the probability that they occur, is different from one league to another. The referee will typically have a random encounter table that lists the chance of encounter for a given area, and will roll one or two d6's for each league of travel; if an encounter occurs, travel stops as the party deals with the situation.

If either party succeeded at moving stealthily, then each member of the other party who was keeping watch rolls Alertness. If they all fail, they are surprised by the encounter.

Line of Sight

Line of sight on perfectly flat terrain and on a clear day only extends for about a league. This means that, barring terrain or weather, the party can usually see midway into the next hex when standing in the middle of a hex, and can fully survey an adjacent hex when standing at its border.

Of course, perfectly flat terrain and perfectly fair weather are almost unheard of deep in the wilds. Fog and precipitation will obscure line of sight, preventing the party from seeing out of their hex; vegetation and various terrain features will also be noted as blocking line of sight across a hex boundary.

Surveying an adjacent hex will likely make the party's Survival check to cross that league easier; the referee is encouraged to be descriptive when detailing the landscape, and the party is encouraged to be descriptive in how they intend to overcome the challenges that they see.

Lookouts

Various points on the map will be designated as lookouts. A lookout is an elevated vantage point that the party could reasonably get to and survey the local landscape.

Weather permitting, a lookout allows the party to see one or even two leagues away in certain directions. A lookout will note both what directions it provides a view in, and the difficulty of any Agility check needed for a creature to ascend it (easy, average, or hard). Detouring onto a lookout typically costs about an hour of travel.

Artificial structures such as watchtowers also dot the landscape, which provide stairs or ladders to easily scale them, and serve as lookouts in all directions when the weather is clear. If a member of the party has a device such as a spyglass, then using it while atop a watchtower might allow them to thoroughly survey an adjacent hex, automatically noticing any terrain features or points of interest that aren't expressly hidden without the need for a task check.

Exploring a Hex

Sometimes, a particular one-league hex merits closer attention paid to it. The next section, Exploration, describes the process primarily as it pertains to a dungeon setting, but any exploration action can also be taken in the wilds. Generally, the referee will subdivide a one-league hex map into half-mile "sub-hexes" and again into 100-pace "exploration zones"; the party can cross five exploration zones (one sub-hex) of clear terrain in one ten-minute exploration turn at a walking pace, or they can spend an entire ten minutes thoroughly investigating a single exploration zone (rolling Alertness, Survival, or any other necessary talents as described in the next section). Many adventures expect the party to explore various hexes, in order to discover hidden lookouts or dungeon entrances.

Tracking, Foraging, and Hunting

Within an exploration zone, characters can forage for food or other resources, or can search for tracks or other clues that another creature has passed through the area. Each of these activities is an exploration action that requires a Survival check, with a difficulty based on the circumstances and the terrain being searched. For example, finding tracks on otherwise untouched snow or similar soft ground is easy, while finding tracks on bare rock with no other clues is hard. Fresh tracks that were laid within the last hour are easier to find, while tracks laid a day or more ago are harder.

Once tracks are found, gathering information from them is another exploration action and Survival check, at a difficulty one level harder than finding the tracks. If the character who finds the tracks has expertise in Survival, that expertise allows them to identify and gather all relevant information from a set of tracks in the same exploration action that they find them. The information that can be gathered includes the kind of creature or object that made the track, how old the tracks are, what direction they went in, as well as any other information the referee deems discoverable.

Foraging and hunting within an exploration zone is also an exploration action requiring a Survival check, with a difficulty that depends on both the terrain and the abundance of the resource being gathered.

Exploring the Dungeon

A party of adventurers explores a dungeon in ten-minute intervals, called exploration turns. During an exploration turn, each player describes to the referee what action their character is performing, then the referee dialogs with them until both sides agree about what is being attempted. The referee then has each character roll whichever of their character's talents the referee deems most appropriate for that action, against a difficulty determined by the nature of the task being attempted. This continues until each player character has performed their action, and then the referee describes the results of the party's actions and a new exploration turn begins.

As mentioned previously, exploration is not limited to the dungeon; the party is welcome to explore areas of open wilderness as well. When they do, the "dungeon" referred to in this chapter refers to an "exploration zone" about a hundred paces across in any direction.

Exploration Actions

Players should be encouraged to describe their characters' actions as creatively and thoroughly as possible. The majority of an exploration turn should happen in a freeform fashion, with the referee describing the basics of what the party immediately sees, hears, smells, and so on as the result of their last actions, and the party then deciding what to do about that information.

Whenever possible, the referee's descriptions will be everything that the player characters can directly perceive, mediated by their Alertness and the limitations of their senses; the players' descriptions will be what their characters do for the next 10 minutes, described in free-form. The referee will then determine for each character's action whether a proficiency test is called for, and direct their players to make any required rolls. Then the next round of exploration begins with the referee's next set of descriptions, which the players respond to with their next set of actions, and so on.

Torchlight and Visibility

A typical lantern will provide enough light to illuminate 10 paces in every direction reasonably well, and illuminate out to 20 paces dimly. This sets a natural movement speed for dungeon exploration at about 100' (20 paces) per exploration turn, limited more by safety and visibility than actual speed. In daylight in the wilderness, the party can reasonably move through up to a half mile (500 paces) per exploration turn.

Torches will typically last 1d6+1 exploration turns, but might require a Finesse check to stay lit if the party is moving quickly or performing complex and risky activities like climbing cliff faces or dodging traps. Lanterns will usually last a full day on one flask of oil, and are easier to keep lit during activities.

Entering a New Area

When the party first enters a new area of the dungeon, the referee should describe to them what they experience at first glance. No rolls are made at this time, but the referee will adjust the level of detail of their description based on the lighting and the characters' Alertness; better Alertness will mean more small details are noticed immediately. Anything "important-looking" within 50 feet (10 paces) or so should be described in moderate detail, with brief descriptions of anything further away, depending on the lighting conditions.

Moving Around

Within an area, the characters can move relatively freely during each exploration turn. A character can move 20 paces and still perform an action, or move 100 times their dash speed as their full exploration action. Areas of difficult terrain, or areas that require extensive climbing, swimming, or jumping to get to, might require an Agility check to navigate.

If the player characters' movements activate a trap, a hazard, or a random encounter with monsters, the referee will stop the action mid-round and describe what is happening, then switch to a combat encounter.

Stealth

The party may choose to move at half speed in order to employ stealth. Each member of the party rolls Stealth, and each monster that is on watch that might notice them rolls Alertness. Medium or heavy armor and being encumbered each make Stealth harder, while intervening walls and distracting background noises make Alertness harder. The party will manage to evade alerting nearby monsters with the sound of their movements either if everyone's Stealth check succeeds, or if each monster's Alertness check fails. If at least one Stealth roll fails and at least one Alertness check succeeds, though, the monsters are alerted and will move to investigate.

Torchlight and other sources of illumination are another matter. Wandering monsters that can see will obviously be alerted to the party's presence if they can see the party's lights and shadows flickering along the walls; choosing between seeing and being seen is a problem that the party will have to figure out as they explore the dungeon.

Watching for Trouble

It's a good idea to have at least one member of the party "on watch" during each round of exploration. Each character on watch rolls an Alertness check to spot any approaching trouble — posting a watch means that if a random encounter occurs, at least someone in the party is likely to be able to act without being surprised. Monster groups will also typically have a few creatures designated as "on watch", which the referee will manage.

Random Encounters

Encounters can happen randomly, either while navigating the wilderness or exploring the dungeon. The referee should make a random encounter roll after the party declares their actions. The referee secretly rolls a single d6, or possibly two d6s and chooses the higher or lower die based on the amount of noise, smell, light, and so on that the party is making. If no event is rolled, then the party continues on with their next round of exploration.

D6	Encounter Check
1-4	No Event
5	Approaching Encounter (within 10 minutes)
6	Random Encounter!

Starting an Encounter

If an encounter or approaching encounter is rolled, the referee rolls on the appropriate Random Encounter table for the party's current location to determine the encounter group, then determines which members of the encounter group were on watch, and whether that group was moving stealthily. The referee then makes Alertness and Stealth checks for the encounter group and compares them with the Alertness and Stealth checks of the party during the exploration turn, to see whether either group notices the other.

If an approaching encounter result is rolled, any party that has been alerted to the other has a full exploration turn to prepare for the upcoming encounter, and the Alertness checks of anyone "on watch" at this time will be easier. If neither party was alerted to the other (due to everyone succeeding at Stealth checks and failing at Alertness checks), then both parties stumble into each other as if the random encounter result had been rolled instead.

If the random encounter result is rolled, the referee announces the encounter to the party, adjusting the level of detail based on the net results of the Stealth and Alertness checks made immediately prior. Creatures whose Stealth or Alertness checks succeed get to act in an additional first round of combat, called the "surprise round", while everyone else is effectively stunned. After that round, everyone on both sides declares their actions and acts in each subsequent round.

Searching for Traps, Hazards, and Secrets

One of the more common actions during exploration is searching for, and disabling or otherwise overcoming, traps and hazards within the dungeon. A hazard is a natural difficulty within the dungeon that must be overcome, such as a crumbling stone bridge or a deep chasm with sheer walls, while a trap is a deliberately constructed hazard, usually with some mechanism of activation.

Traps and hazards may be obvious or hidden. An obvious trap or hazard is noticeable as soon as the party has line of sight to it; any hidden traps or hazards must be detected with Alertness checks.

Generally, the process of searching for hidden features should be spelled out in detail (if a player declares “I search for traps” as their action, the proper response from the referee should be “okay, how?”), with those details interacting with the nature of the trap to determine difficulty. A well-hidden trap might be naturally hard to search for, but might be easy instead if the player notices the right details from the room’s description and focuses their attention in the right place.

Properly described searches might very well set a difficulty of automatic, with no roll necessary; if the players figure out a particular puzzle simply from the initial description given to them, the referee should simply reward them for their ingenuity and move on. Likewise, if they are simply not searching in the right area or using the right methods at all, the difficulty is impossible and no d6 task check is required. It’s only when a search action has some degree of risk or chance involved that a player should roll their character’s Alertness (or possibly another talent, such as Finesse or Science) to see if they succeed.

An Alertness check to search for traps also searches for hidden doors or passages; if a door is discovered, it may turn out to be open, locked, barred, or blocked. Finding a hidden door is much like finding a hidden trap; there is a default difficulty for noticing it during any search, while a search that focuses on the right area and uses the right methods should be easier or even automatic.

Overcoming Natural Hazards

Most natural hazards can be avoided or overcome with an Agility check or a strength check. Clever solutions might instead involve “dungeoneering” something clever out of available materials and resources; the referee will assign d6 task checks and difficulties appropriate to the players’ descriptions.

Kicking In Doors and Moving Obstacles

Barred doors, blocked hallways, and the like often do not have any way to 'pick' them; instead, they must be overcome with strength checks, in a fashion similar to overcoming a hazard. Unlike a hazard, failing to overcome a barred door or blocked hallway will usually not trigger an attack or inflict damage, unless there is a hidden hazard or trap built into the blockage. The threshold for the strength check depends on the obstruction; breaking down a thin wooden door might be a 3+, while clearing a massive boulder wedged into a cave passage could be as high as 7+. Applying leverage might make a strength check easier or harder depending on the method used, based on the referee's judgment. Multiple creatures can apply their strength at once to such a task; each creature's attempt might be easy or hard based on their technique and positioning, and then their check results all add together vs. the obstacle's threshold.

Disarming Traps

Traps with at least some physical parts can usually be disabled with a Finesse check. The difficulty of this test is determined by the complexity of the hazard or trap, and by how much effort the trap-maker went to conceal its inner workings.

If the party stops to examine the trap in detail first, a successful Science check might reveal some clues as to its principle of operations, which might suggest specific approaches to disarming it that might make the Finesse check to do so easier.

Picking Locks

A locked door, whether hidden or obvious, must either be unlocked with the proper key, picked, or bashed in. Unlocking a lock with the proper key is usually a simple task, but might occasionally require a Finesse test to get the sequence right. Picking a lock operates identically to disarming a trap — mechanical locks are first inspected, then picked with a Finesse roll. Obvious locks will sometimes have hidden traps, which activate and attack anyone trying to inspect or pick them. If no one explicitly searches the lock for hidden traps, then they activate them automatically when they first attempt to pick the lock. Otherwise, disabling the trap before picking the lock proceeds normally, after which the lock may be safely picked.

Finesse Expertise

Scouts, Delves and Dweomersmiths are the three classes with expertise in Finesse; picking locks and disabling traps is part of their basic class training. As such, the difficulty for picking a lock or disabling a trap is assumed to be the difficulty for a Finesse expert to attempt it; anyone without this expertise will at least have a harder time with their Finesse check, assuming they can even make the attempt at all.

Dungeoneering

The party may create obstructions and traps, rather than removing them. Barring doors or blocking passages with heavy objects are typically feats of strength, while locking doors is often as simple as turning a latch – although some locks may need to be ‘unpicked’ back into a locking position if the key isn’t found. Glamours such as shape earth can make the creation and clearing of hazards trivial, and spells such as forceful hand can be used to perform necessary feats of strength.

Whenever the party adjusts the layout of the dungeon, either by opening new passageways or blocking them off, the referee should note the changes on their map and adjust the behavior of any patrolling or wandering monsters as necessary. Wise adventurers will be careful about leaving a trail through the dungeon, which hostile monsters might use to track them down and ambush them.

Hiding the results of dungeoneering is itself a dungeoneering task, creating a situation where the monsters now need to be as wary of hidden traps as the players. Of course, if the players don’t bother to mark on their maps where they placed hidden traps, or don’t bother to check those maps when re-entering a room, it is certainly not the referee’s job to remind them.

Crafting Traps and Hazards

Players can, of course, construct traps as well as disabling them. Constructing a mechanical trap begins with the player describing the kind of trap they wish to construct, followed by a Science check to design the mechanisms, followed by a series of Finesse checks to construct each component. Feats of strength might also be required to dig out areas or haul large components into place.

Once the trap is set up, the referee determines the base difficulties to detect, inspect, and disable the trap, and the nature of the attack that the trap will perform, based on the results of the designer’s Science check and the builders’ Finesse checks. If the designer stays to inspect the work as it progresses, the referee should give them feedback about the detect, inspect, and disable difficulties, and the details of the trap’s attack, to allow them to make adjustments to the design or focus more attention on specific sections to improve them.

Repairing Ruined Wonders

One of the primary tasks for an adventuring team will be appraising the condition of ruined wonders, and – if possible – restoring them to their former glory. Understanding the purpose of a ruined wonder is a Lore check; inspecting it for damage, once its purpose is understood, is a Science check. Succeeding at both gives the party some idea of what repairs will be necessary, and what level of functionality can be expected if they succeed.

Social Encounters

During an adventure, the party should engage with other creatures. Not all of these interactions need to resort to violence; in fact, most of them probably shouldn't.

Non-Player Characters

Each non-player character has its own goals, motivations, and needs, and the party can choose to leverage those in service to its own. Non-player characters track abilities, saving throws, talents, and hit points as if they were player characters.

Attitude

One of the more important aspects of a non-player character is their attitude towards the party. Attitude is a spectrum that typically ranges from hostile to helpful - a hostile NPC will attack or attempt to harm the player characters on sight if at all possible, while a helpful NPC will try to help the party in any way they can, if doing so isn't directly harmful to themselves or their other interests. The player characters generally don't need to make social tests for any creature that is hostile or helpful; it's the attitudes in between that are most relevant in a social encounter.

An NPC that is neither hostile nor helpful can be unfriendly, indifferent, or friendly. Unfriendly NPCs will be "disinclined to acquiesce" to any request made of them, while friendly NPCs will tend to help if they can do so without any particular inconvenience on their part. Honest bargaining with unfriendly NPCs is usually harder, while honest bargaining with friendly NPCs is usually easier. Deception, coercion, and bribery can mitigate an unfriendly NPC's attitude, of course, just as clear disrespect or a bad deal can negate the advantages of bargaining with friendly creatures.

Unless otherwise specified, the referee will roll a 2d6 to determine a creature's attitude, modified by its nature and circumstances.

2d6	Attitude	Effects
2-3	Hostile	Likely to attack on sight
4-5	Unfriendly	Likely to hinder the party
6-8	Indifferent	Pursues their own goals
9-10	Friendly	Likely to help the party
11-12	Helpful	Helps if not too dangerous

Influencing NPCs

If a player character has a chance to greet an NPC in a non-hostile manner, the player and referee should roleplay out the first few minutes of engagement before having the player make their first Charm check, with a difficulty based on their performance. The result will determine that NPC's "first impression", which will adjust that NPC's 2d6 Attitude roll up or down accordingly. From that point forward, whenever you interact with that NPC during an exploration turn, you can focus your attention on a goal (getting the NPC to perform some task for you) or you can focus your attention on the relationship (cultivating the NPC's attitude to be more friendly to you).

Focusing on the relationship means you'll make a Charm test as your exploration action, while focusing on the goal means you'll make a Wit check. If the NPC is suspicious, they might make a saving throw vs. Trick or Fear to resist your Charm or Wit, negating your attempt if they succeed. Each side's roll will be made harder or easier by the actual words and actions exchanged.

A successful Charm action won't influence the NPC's actions directly, but will temporarily improve their attitude by one step - and if this leads to them choosing to act in your interest and doing so turns out well for them, that improvement in attitude might become permanent if cultivated further.

A successful Wit action, on the other hand, will convince the NPC to do or believe what you want them to, but won't influence their attitude - and if the result of their subsequent actions turns out badly for them, it's likely to worsen their attitude towards you in the future unless you repair the broken trust. The NPC's current attitude corresponds directly to the difficulty of a Wit test needed to convince them of anything, absent other circumstances.

In certain circumstances, where you are simply coercing an NPC through threats and stubbornness, you might make a Bearing check instead of a Wit check to force their action, but doing so is almost guaranteed to worsen their attitude; in other situations, an already friendly NPC might be convinced to help you of their own accord through sheer Charm and friendliness.

Recruiting Followers

Each player character can collect a retinue of followers, limited by their Bearing.

Bearing	Maximum Followers
6+	1
5+	2
4+	3
3+	4
2+	5

if gaining a new follower causes a player character's retinue to exceed their Bearing, that character finds it harder to manage all their followers until they let enough of them go to fall under the limit.

To recruit a new follower, the player character first presents their case; if the referee deems it sufficiently convincing for that particular creature, the player makes a Charm check at a difficulty based on the appeal of the offer and the prospective recruit's current attitude; on a success, the NPC decides to join the retinue. Demonstrated loyalty and offered incentives make this check easier, while extenuating circumstances may make it harder.

Keep a few personality notes about each follower NPC in your party's retinues; giving each of the party's followers a distinct voice and personality goes a long way towards fostering immersion and engagement.

Hirelings

The simplest way to gain followers is to pay them. The minimum pay that any civilized follower will expect for their services is one silver dinar per day; most will also expect at least a half-share of any treasure found.

Follower Loyalty

Each member of the party's retinue is an NPC under the control of the referee. Helpful followers will obey orders to the best of their ability, while merely friendly followers might weigh the potential risks and rewards before jumping into a dangerous situation. Followers whose attitudes fall to indifferent have become unhappy with their lot, and are likely to abandon the group at the first opportunity; a follower whose temperament falls all the way to unfriendly or hostile will most likely actively mutiny, possibly violently, as soon as they see a good opportunity to do so.

Follower Morale

Followers need to make morale checks at various times, such as when placed in direct danger or asked to perform a task that goes against their own nature or judgment. Morale checks are saving throws vs. Fear, with a difficulty based on the follower's loyalty.

A disgruntled follower will typically bring the mood of the entire party down, sowing dissension and distrust among the ranks. The player character leading the retinue finds all tests managing any followers with an attitude other than Helpful harder as long as at least one follower is actively Unfriendly or Hostile, and all morale checks for each of their followers are similarly affected.

Directing Followers

Bearing is also used to determine whether followers obey orders when under duress, in dangerous or stressful situations, or when the orders are unclear or complex. A Bearing check can be made in most situations to quickly determine if plans go awry due to lack of coordination or failures in morale; this check will be normal difficulty for naturally Friendly followers, easy for Helpful followers, or hard for Indifferent followers.

Beast Companions

In addition to followers, player characters with expertise in Survival can gain a second retinue of beast companions - using their Survival rather than Bearing to determine the total hit dice worth of trained animals that they can manage. Other player characters who do not have expertise in Survival might gain a trained domesticated animal as a companion at the referee's discretion (usually a riding mount or trained hunting dogs).

Beast companions are under the referee's control, acting on their own initiative, and using their own movement and action as normal. They will usually obey the commands of their handler to the best of their understanding, training, and temperament.

Riding mounts can usually be commanded by the rider as part of their action in combat, if the mount has sufficient temperament and training to take direction well. Controlling a less compliant mount requires the rider's full action, if it is even possible.

Combat Encounters

When combat begins, each creature that isn't surprised gets to act in the first round, which is also called the *surprise round*. After the surprise round is over, all creatures in the encounter who are capable of action may do so.

Combat Actions

Each creature that can act declares their action at the start of the round. Possible actions are:

Attack (speed: per weapon) – move up to 5 paces and make a weapon attack. Attempting to make a ranged weapon attack or move out of melee will provoke attacks of opportunity.

Dash (speed: normal) – move up to 20 paces if unencumbered, or up to 10 paces if encumbered.

Evade (speed: fast) – move up to 5 paces, and it is harder to hit you for the rest of this round. You must have a Dexterity of +1 or better and be unencumbered to evade.

Guard (speed: normal) – You can perform one opportunity attack each phase, and you may move up to 2 paces between each phase. Only fighter classes can guard.

Magic (speed: slow) – Attempt to cast a spell, glamour, or miracle, or use a magic item. You must declare what you attempting to cast, and you cannot move while casting.

Task (speed: normal) – perform some other action (such as attempting to hide, or interacting with the environment in some way). The referee will determine whether you can also move.

Order of Actions

After each creature declares their action, combat proceeds in three phases. First, all fast actions occur; then, all normal actions occur, and finally, all slow actions occur. Actions will normally happen simultaneously; if the order of two actions in a single phase matters, each acting creature can make a Dexterity check, with the winner choosing whether to act first or last.

Evading and **Guarding** are special actions, in that they focus more on reacting to other creatures and events rather than performing a single action. Evading lets you move during the fast phase, and then you are harder to hit for the round. Guarding skips your action, but lets you make an opportunity attack during each phase of the round, and move up to 2 phases between each phase.

Action and Movement

Unless a creature's action or circumstances prevent movement, it can move as it performs its action. Each character has a natural movement rate of 5 paces (25 feet) over even ground; difficult terrain or a heavy burden halves this movement speed, to three paces per round. Dashing increases your movement to 20 paces per round if you are unencumbered, at the cost of not being able to do anything else that round. If you are within reach of another creature's melee attacks, you provoke an opportunity attack from it as you move out of its reach.

Encumbrance

You are encumbered if you are wearing too much gear or carrying too heavy a load. Your maximum carrying capacity is equal to 6 + your Strength ability. In addition to armor and weapons, each 25 lb of carried gear or treasure adds +1 to encumbrance. An oversized weapon or gear such as a polearm will also add an additional +1.

As long as your carried armor and gear isn't more than half your carrying capacity, you can move and act normally. Past this, up to your carrying capacity, you are encumbered; the dash rate of an encumbered character is halved to 10 paces per round, and you can't evade. Past your full carrying capacity, you are burdened – your speed is halved (to 3 paces per combat round), your actions are always slow, and you can't dash or evade.

Weapons

A weapon's size determines its damage, how many hands it takes to wield it, and whether it can be held in the off hand. A creature wielding one weapon in each hand makes a single attack throw, then adds both weapons' damage together if the attack hits. Some weapons have additional properties, such as parrying, piercing, stunning, or sundering; these properties will be described later.

Weapon Size	Damage	Attack Speed	Encumbrance	Wielded
Light	1d6	Fast	0	off- or one-handed
Medium	1d6+Str	Normal	0	one-handed*
Medium	2d6	Normal	0	two-handed
Heavy	2d6+Str	Slow	1	two-handed*
Heavy Polearm	2d6+Str	Slow	2	two-handed*

** Due to their small size, gnomes can't wield heavy weapons, and must wield medium weapons two-handed.*

Armor

Armor reduces the damage of each weapon by its defense, to a minimum of zero damage per weapon. Most armors offer no protection from elemental or magical attacks.

Armor Type	Defense	Evade Speed	Encumbrance	Other Properties
Light	1	Fast	1	
Medium	2	Normal	2	Steel
Heavy	3	Slow	3	Steel, Hardened

In addition to armor, some character classes can use shields. A shield is wielded in your off hand, preventing you from wielding weapons with that hand. In exchange, you are harder to hit with any attack that you are aware of, as long as you are capable of moving your shield to block it.

Reacting to Other Creatures

Each creature that can act can also react to other creature's actions even if it isn't their turn to act yet, as long as the acting creature's action affects the reacting creature.

Usually, you only get to either act or react to one thing in a round; once you've reacted, you can't perform any more actions or reactions for the rest of the round. This means that if you react to something before it's your turn to act, you will lose your action.

The most straightforward reaction is the **opportunity attack**. If you've declared the attack or guard action and haven't made your attack yet, you can immediately make your attack against it if it attempts to perform a **provoking** action while within reach of your melee weapon. Since you're attacking before your attack would normally happen, you don't also get to move.

Your own attack interrupts its action; if you hit, the creature you hit loses the rest of its action. The most common provoking actions that a creature can make are attempting to step away from you, attempting to make a ranged attack, or attempting to cast magic.

If you're a fighter class (Warrior, Stalwart or Champion), the **guard** action lets a you give up you own attack action to allow you to make multiple opportunity attacks in a round instead. You can make an opportunity attack in response to one fast action, one normal action, and one slow action, and you can move up to 2 paces in between the fast and normal phases of the round, and again in between the normal and slow phases.

Whenever you successfully save vs. Blast against an area effect that might harm you, you can perform another reaction, called a **dodge**. To dodge, you make a hard Dexterity check, then move that many paces before the blast goes off. If you manage to get out of the blast area, it doesn't affect you at all.

Another kind of reaction that you can make is a **parry**, in response to an attack that's about to hit you. You need to be wielding a weapon with the parry property in order to parry; if you are, you can give up your own attack to force the attacker to re-roll theirs.

Magic in Combat

Casting in a combat encounter is slower and riskier than other combat actions. You must declare to the referee what effect you intend to cast. If another creature hits you with an attack after you declare your effect but before you can cast it, you must save vs. Doom or your magic is disrupted.

Some magics are **fast** to perform. A fast magic can be performed in reaction to another action in combat, even if the caster hadn't originally declared that they were casting magic this round. They simply switch their action to casting the magic, then do so.

Stunts and Maneuvers

In a combat encounter, you are encouraged to think tactically and creatively. Unless otherwise specified, these combat options are available for any creature to use if the circumstances are appropriate. The following options are a common, but by no means exhaustive, list of combat maneuvers that may be performed if the circumstances favor them. The referee and players are also welcome to come up with new maneuvers to add to their own game.

Brace

If you are wielding a polearm with the piercing property, you may brace it into the ground as you choose the guard action. You choose a direction as you brace your weapon; if a creature charges you from that direction, you may make an opportunity attack against it which gains +1d6 of damage for each 5 full paces the target moved towards you, and which ignores all armor (even heavy armor).

Charge

A charge combines a dash and attack into a single action. Charging is always a slow action, going in the last phase of the round. For every 5 full paces that you move directly towards your target, your attack gains +1d6 damage. If you hit, your target is shoved backwards, and you end your movement in the target's space.

Disarm or Pilfer

You can attempt to disarm a target with your attack, but doing so makes your attack throw harder. If you hit, and one or more damage dice exceed your Finesse threshold, your opponent must make a save vs. Hold or drop their weapon. A Scout can attempt to disarm or pick a pocket by making a Finesse check instead of a weapon damage roll after hitting with a melee attack. If the Scout succeeds, they pilfer or plant one reachable item of their choice.

Grab or Shove

You can attempt to shove or grab a target by making a melee attack roll with a difficulty based on the relative size of the target. A grab attack must be made with a free hand or a flail weapon, while a shove can be made with any melee attack. If you hit, the target makes a save vs. Hold to halve the damage and avoid being grabbed, moved, or knocked prone.

Wait

If you want to wait for a specific event to occur before performing your action, you can do so. For example, you might want to attack an enemy as it moves past you.

Damage and Ongoing Conditions

Damage that gets through your armor reduces your hit points. If your hit points are reduced below half your maximum, you are injured; if they are reduced to zero, you are dying.

Whenever you inflict damage with an attack, if any of the damage dice roll a '6', an additional effect is inflicted on the target. This effect depends on the type of damage inflicted. The attacker can also force the affected target to make a save vs. Hold to avoid being knocked down or pushed back (attacker's choice) by the force of the blow, if they wish. This saving throw is easy if only one '6' was rolled in the damage roll, or hard if two or more '6's were rolled.

Weapon Damage

Physical attacks that roll a '6' usually inflict ongoing **bleeding**. A bleeding creature loses hit points equal to half its level (round up) at the start of each round until it saves vs. Doom to stop bleeding; it or an ally can also use its action to make a Medicine check to attempt to staunch the flow.

Physical attacks with the **blunt** property stun instead of dealing ongoing damage, causing the target to lose their next action when any damage die rolls a '6'.

Physical attacks with the **piercing** property ignore light or medium armor when inflicting their damage.

Attacks with the **sundering** property reduce the target's armor by 1 per '6' rolled until repaired. If the target has a shield, each '6' rolled affects the shield instead.

Elemental Damage

Elemental damage effects depend on the element. Many elemental attacks, such as acid, poison, or fire, can inflict ongoing damage. Many others, such as psychic, cold, thunder, lightning, or radiant, might stun the target. Thunder and radiant damage can also affect the target's senses, deafening or blinding them for a round. Cold or petrification might hobble or restrain the target until they break free, and acid can sunder armor or weapons. Psychic damage might frighten or confuse the target for a round.

Critical Hits

If an attack throw rolls a '20', it's a critical hit. Scouts and hunters can also sneak attack to cause a critical hit if the damage dice roll high enough, and fighters achieve a critical hit whenever their attack roll beats its threshold by 10 or more.

When a creature suffers a critical hit, it immediately saves vs. Doom after the main attack damage is applied. If it successfully saves, it loses half its current hit points (round the loss down, so a successful save will never drop a creature to zero hit points); if it fails, its hit points drop to zero and it is dying.

Combat Conditions

Blind - A creature can be blinded by various circumstances. A blind creature considers all other creatures effectively concealed by it. A creature might sometimes be able to end this condition with a successful save vs. Doom.

Concealed - a creature can be partially or totally concealed by cover. A partially concealed creature is harder to hit, while a fully concealed creature cannot be attacked unless the attacker has some way of knowing where they are.

Dying - A creature with zero hp is dying. A dying creature is also unconscious, and whenever it suffers further damage, it must save vs. Doom or die.

At the end of each round, after all other creatures have acted, each dying creature must save vs. Doom or die. If its saving throw rolls a '20', it stabilizes to one hit point and is no longer dying, but it's still unconscious and helpless until it wakes up.

Another creature can attempt to stabilize a dying creature with a hard Medicine check. On a success, the dying creature stabilizes to one hit point and is no longer dying, but it's still unconscious and helpless until it wakes up.

Hobbled / Prone - Various attacks or other circumstances might hobble a creature. A hobbled creature can only move 3 paces per round, and can't dash or evade.

A creature might sometimes be able to end this condition with a successful save vs. Hold. Being knocked prone is similar to being hobbled, but a prone creature can stand up during their next action unless they're somehow restrained from doing so.

Injured - A creature that has lost half of its hit points is injured, and will need either magic, or time and medical attention, in order to heal.

Panicked - A panicked creature can't attack, and must attempt to move as far away from the source of its fear (dashing if possible). If it can't move, it cowers in place as far away as it can get.

Stunned - A stunned creature loses its action for the rest of the combat round, causing it to be unable to act, react, or move. However, it isn't considered helpless.

Unconscious / Helpless - A helpless creature can't move, act, or react, and all attacks against it are easy. An unconscious creature is helpless, and also completely unaware of its surroundings. At the end of the round, any unconscious creature that isn't dying makes an Alertness check to attempt to wake up.

Resting and Healing

Player characters who are injured or fatigued can choose to rest in the dungeon, although doing so is hazardous. Resting requires relative safety, peace, and quiet; an encounter always interrupts a rest.

Crafting, Repair, and Preparation

Some magic-users can attempt to re-prepare magics during an exploration turn, while other characters can roll Finesse checks to attempt to craft ammunition, make simple repairs to damaged equipment, or perform other tasks of similar complexity.

Tending to the Injured

Fatigue

Characters and other creatures who have lost less than half of their hit points are merely fatigued, rather than actually injured. Each exploration turn of rest allows a fatigued creature to roll one hit die, then regain that many hit points. A resting creature can perform no other actions that round.

Injury

A creature is injured if it has lost half or more of its hit points. Without magic, healing actual injury is a slow and arduous process, which cannot be done in the dungeon. A character can use Medicine attempt to treat an injured character immediately after an injury, if both of them spend an exploration action tending to the wounds. On a success, the injured character rolls one hit die and recovers that many hit points. If this heals them above half their hit points, they are no longer injured; otherwise, no further non-magical healing will be possible until they return home from the dungeon, or find another suitable hospice.

This first-aid attempt can only be made once, in the hour immediately after the injury is sustained; once this opportunity has passed, non-magical healing is no longer possible in the dungeon for that character.

Healing Magic and Potions

Magic can also heal injury or fatigue, and can even be used during exploration or in combat. Priests have access to healing magic directly, while wizards, dwarves, and druids may brew up healing elixirs to aid the injured.

Interrupted Rests

Resting in the dungeon is risky and leaves the party somewhat vulnerable to attack, prompting the referee to roll for a random encounter. If the party is interrupted by a random encounter while resting, they do not regain any resources or hit points, and are automatically surprised by the encounter. Most parties will post a watch while the rest of the party rests, guaranteeing that at least one character will be ready to respond to any threats should they arise.

Camping Overnight

If the party must camp in the dungeon overnight, their sleep must be uninterrupted for at least six hours, and they must not be excessively hungry or thirsty. Each uninjured character rolls all their hit dice and adds them together, then regains up to that many hp if the result is higher than their current hp total. Magic-users may then begin preparing any daily magics at the next dawn or dusk.

Preparing Magic

Wizards and dweomersmiths can prepare their full set of magics at dawn or dusk after a six hour rest in the dungeon. This process takes one hour (six exploration turns), but does not require any task checks or saving throws. If a magic-user is interrupted while preparing their daily magic, they are automatically surprised.

Deprivation

Each day that a character cannot get a clean drink, a full meal, and at least 6 hours of sleep without being interrupted, they do not regain hit points. Until they have gained enough food, water, and sleep, all their rolls will be harder, and they cannot prepare spells, prayers, or other magics. If they go more than three days without rest or water, they begin suffering 1d6 hit points of damage per day until they die.

Recuperating From Injuries

Injured creatures that are not poisoned or diseased will regain hit points slowly, over several days (or even weeks) of bedrest. Roll one hit die, then consult the following chart based on the result and the character's level to determine the total number of days of rest needed to heal the next hit point:

Hit Die Result:	1	2	3	4	5	6+
Level 1	14	7	5	4	3	2
Level 2	7	5	3	2	2	1
Level 3	5	3	2	2	1	1
Level 4	4	2	2	1	1	½
Level 5	3	2	1	1	½	½
Level 6+	2	1	1	½	½	⅓

Any strenuous activity will completely undo the current round of recuperation, requiring a new hit die roll. Recuperating in dungeon conditions makes this roll hard, or might even make it impossible; recuperating under proper medical care instead makes the roll easy.

Another character may make a Medicine roll once per day to attempt to help tend to their wounds; the difficulty of this roll is based on the available medical supplies and facilities. Success reduces their recuperation time by one day, or automatically heals an additional hit point if the recuperation time is already less than one day. Once the injured character has rested the necessary number of days, they heal one hit point and roll again.

Returning Home

Experience

Whenever you complete an experience milestone and then arrive safely home, your character gains one experience. Once you've gained as many experiences as your next class level, reset your experience total to zero and advance your class level by 1. If you're starting as a first level character with no experience, you will gain your second class level as soon as you achieve two experiences.

Prime Abilities

Each class has a prime ability, which adjusts the rate at which experience levels in that class are gained. If your prime ability is -1 or lower, you will require additional experience to advance.

Hit Dice, Attacks, and Saves

Once you gain a class level, you immediately gain a hit die and any other features from your new class level, up to a maximum of nine hit dice. Roll all your hit dice and add them together; if the result is higher than your character's maximum hit points, set your new maximum hit points to the rolled result.

Gaining a class level reduces each of your saving throw and attack throw thresholds by one, to a minimum threshold of 5+.

Expertise Training

Expert classes gain training in a talent of their choice each time they gain a class level, while magic-user classes gain training in a specific talent at each even class level. Fighters instead choose and gain a new fighter feat that they do not already possess at each even level.

For experts, which talents were used in the last set of adventures should have some bearing on which gets trained; if there is no clear talent that a character focused on during the last few adventures, then training whichever talent has the worst threshold is usually a safe bet. Referees and players might maintain a tradition of declaring which talents they intend to train at their next level, before they even earn the experience to do so.

Class-Based Experience

In addition to surviving adventures, each class gains additional experience based on its actions during the adventure. Members of the party split their accomplishments between all members of the same class group once they have successfully returned home; if an individual's share of the tally reaches the appropriate milestone for their level, they gain one bonus experience for that adventure. The referee might also award specific player characters extra experience for exceptional cleverness or bravery during an adventure.

Fighters

Fighters gain additional experience through combat. Each level of foe defeated, whether through death, surrender, or fleeing, is added to the tally group's tally, which is divided evenly among all fighters at the end of the adventure. Large and huge monsters count as 2x and 5x their level, respectively.

Experts

Experts gain additional experience through recovering treasure. The gold cost of all mundane (non-magical) treasure brought back from the adventure is tallied, then divided evenly among all experts (regardless of how the actual loot is divvied up).

Magic-Users

Each class of magic-user has their own goals, which determine what accomplishments gain them additional experience.

Priests gain additional experience through accomplishing the goals of their faith. They track enemies defeated in the same manner as fighters, but if the party willingly kills a mortal that could have reasonably been redeemed instead, no priest that participated in the murder gains experience for the entire adventure. Priests also count the levels of any allies that they save from mortal peril towards their accomplishments, as well as the levels of any creatures willingly converted to the Faith. Tally all of these levels together, then divide them evenly between all priests that participated.

Wizards and dweomersmiths gain additional experience through studying magic. The circle or rarity of each new magic item or arcane spell discovered counts towards their tally.

Druids gain experience by studying fey creatures in their natural habitat; each new kind of fey creature observed for a full hour counts its level towards the druid's tally. Restoring the balance of a damaged ecosystem might automatically grant all druids in the party an extra experience.

Class-Based Experience Milestones

Level	Foes	Treasure	Magic
1	2 levels	750 gold	1 circle
2	3 levels	1,000 gold	1 circle
3	4 levels	1,500 gold	1 circle
4	6 levels	2,000 gold	2 circles
5	9 levels	3,000 gold	3 circles
6	15 levels	5,000 gold	5 circles
7	25 levels	10,000 gold	10 circles
8	40 levels	15,000 gold	15 circles